Bean there, Coded that

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On January 23rd, 1996 Sun Microsystems released a programming language that would take over the world, with the Java Development Kit 1.0 (Java Version Almanac, n.d.). Initially the language was restricted to paying customers however in 2006, OpenJDK was released as an open source version of the Java language under the GNU General public license (Oracle, n.d.).

Java is a very versatile language capable of running a wide range of applications from video games to business applications. It is versatile because of the execution method. Java code is compiled into bytecode, then the Java Virtual Machine interprets or JIT-compiles that into machine instructions, allowing a vast majority of systems to run it (Oracle, n.d.).

Initially the language was going to be named Oak, however it was changed to Java to honor the abundant amount of coffee beans consumed during the development of the language (Oracle, n.d.). In 2010, Oracle completed its acquisition of Sun Microsystems for approximately $7.4 billion, and Oracle continues to support the OpenJDK community (Oracle, 2010).

Today, Java has several licensing tiers for developers. The first is Oracle JDK, which is Oracle's official Java distribution. Second, there is OpenJDK which currently uses the GNU GPL v2 license with the classpath exception, allowing developers to use the language without requiring them to use an open source license. Lastly there is the commercial use license which is reserved for businesses who need access to a consistently updated and stable language (Oracle, n.d.).

In conclusion, Java is a versatile language that has many useful features such as performance optimizations and an object oriented design. It also features open source frameworks for developers to contribute to or use. These features are what have allowed Java to

stay relevant, with it still being used for many enterprise systems, web apps, and more (Oracle, n.d.)

References

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